The main conclusion from figure 2.7 can be summarized as the following key point.

KEY POINT A data mesh is for socio-technically complex organizations with complex data needs.

If you decide that the socio-technical and data complexities in your organization may justify giving data mesh a shot, the following section will show you what takes to implement one.

2.3 Understanding a data mesh implementation effort

If you performed the driver analysis described in section 2.1, you should know whether the implementation of a data mesh would bring value to your organization. Now is the right time to consider the requirements to make it happen and whether they are worth the effort. To answer this question, we will walk you through the steps we propose to take and the structures to apply on the organizational level to implement a data mesh.

We will not get into details of technological solutions and their associated costs. There are simply too many possibilities to list them all here. However, we believe that after reading this book, especially chapters 7 and 8, you will be able to create a reasonable estimation for your situation. For now, let’s see an overview of the implementation process.

2.3.1 The data mesh development cycle

In our experience, a data mesh implementation works best if its development is similar to CI/CD-based software development. Small steps taken in cycles ensure quick wins, rapid feedback and correction ability, and flexibility in reaction to changes. Figure 2.8 shows the high-level overview of the development process.